Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held Electronically
At 1:00 p.m. on December 13, 2021

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
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Present:	Chair - Councillor	R. Tyler Morin
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	L. Bower
		A. Khan
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Tyler Morin called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on November 15, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Special Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the special meeting of the General Government Committee held on November 23, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.3 2022 Capital Budget & 2023-2031 Long Range Capital Forecast Meeting

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the 2022 Capital Budget & 2023-2031 Lang Range Capital Forecast Meeting of the General Government Committee held on November 29, 2021 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.4, 4.5, 4.6 and 4.7 for discussion.

Moved by: L. Bower

That items 4.3, 4.8 and 4.9 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 FIN-2021-20: Library Memorandum of Understanding 2021

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for the stabilization reserve, special reserves, and capital reserves including intended use of the reserves. Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian and Executive Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council receive and endorse the Memorandum of Understanding between the Town of Ajax and the Library; and

2. That Council authorize the Chief Administrative Officer to execute the MOU.

CARRIED

4.2 FIN-2021-21: 2021 Operating Budget Forecast and COVID Related Financial Impact

Committee Members asked questions regarding accuracy of the projected annual operating budget forecast for 2021, allocation of operating budget surplus, timelines associated with reserve allocation recommendations, naming requirements for the new reserve, and justifications for the August 31st date. Dianne Valentim, Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Main Motion

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the Report on the 2021 Operating Budget Forecast and COVID-related Financial Impact be received for information; and

2. That a new Public Health Outbreak reserve be established to transfer funds not utilized under the Safe Restart Grant and COVID Recovery Funding received in 2021.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That clause 2 be amended to read as follows:

2. That a new Public Health reserve be established to transfer funds not utilized under the Safe Restart Grant and COVID Recovery Funding received in 2021.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the Report on the 2021 Operating Budget Forecast and COVID-related Financial Impact be received for information; and

2. That a new Public Health reserve be established to transfer funds not utilized under the Safe Restart Grant and COVID Recovery Funding received in 2021.

CARRIED

4.3 **LIS-2021-21: 2021 Provincial Accessibility Compliance Report**

Moved by: L. Bower

That the 2021 Town of Ajax Accessibility Compliance Report (ATT-1) be approved for submission to the Ministry for Seniors and Accessibility.

CARRIED

4.4 **LIS-2021-22: AMHC Update**

Committee Members asked questions regarding communication strategies for the strategic plan, opportunities to partner with program liaisons within the community and not-for-profit organizations, and projected timelines for reopening common areas in AMHC buildings. Kevin Bradley, General Manager, Ajax Municipal Housing Corporation, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the report entitled “AMHC Update” be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 **LIS-2021-23: Animal Sheltering Service Proposals**

Committee Members asked questions regarding costs for disposal of large deadstock and opportunities to consider the City of Pickering option in the future. Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the report entitled “Animal Sheltering Service Proposals” be received for information.

CARRIED

4.6 LIS-2021-24: Contract Award – Managed Security Services Provider (MSSP)

Committee Members asked questions regarding increased annual costs, scope of services, on demand support services, methods to mitigate cybersecurity risk, performance provisions, advanced threat detection, cybersecurity insurance premiums, and systems integration and compatibility. N. Cooper, Chris Walker, Manager of Technology & Innovation, and D. Valentim, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Council award the contract for a Managed Security Service Provider (MSSP) to CDW, for the estimated amount of $201,140.00 (inclusive of all taxes), for a period of one year.

2. That Council authorize Staff to renew the contract for an additional two, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $402,280.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

3. That Council provide pre-budget approval in the amount of $144,000 to be included in the 2022 Technology and Innovation operating budget.

CARRIED

4.7 OES-2021-16: Contract Award – Rossland Road Reconstruction from Church Street to Westney Road

Committee Members asked questions regarding rationale for increased project costs, status of road rationalization discussions with the Region, opportunities to maintain priority for Rossland Road, timelines for proposed intersection improvements along Rossland Road, and construction timelines for the widening of Rossland Road from Church Street to Westney Road. Ranil Fernando, Manager of Infrastructure & Asset Management, Dave Meredith, Director of Operations & Environmental Services, and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council award the contract for Rossland Road Reconstruction from Church Street to Westney Road to Grascan Construction Limited in the amount of $10,090,900.00 (inclusive of all taxes).

2. That Council approve the following funding, to be allocated to Capital Account No. 1018611:

Development Charges Reserve Fund	$2,543,485.89
Development Reserve	$ 510,748.07

Total $3,054,233.96

3. That Council award the contract for the Contract Administration and Material Testing to R.V. Anderson in the amount of $764,675.67 (inclusive of all taxes) for Rossland Road Reconstruction from Church Street to Westney Road.

4. That the Mayor and Clerk be authorized to execute the Agreement to Professional Consulting Services, between the Town of Ajax and R.V. Anderson Associates Limited for contract administration and inspection services for Rossland Road Reconstruction from Church Street to Westney Road.

CARRIED

4.8 OES-2021-14: Contract Award – Block Tree Pruning Services

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Staff award the contract for Block Pruning Service, to Ontario Line Clearing & Tree Experts Inc. in the estimated amount of $167,637.76 (inclusive of all taxes), for a period of one year.

2. That Staff be authorized to renew the contract for an additional two, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $350,513.80 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

4.9 OES-2021-15: Contract Award – Accessible Pedestrian Signal Installation – Region of Durham

Moved by: L. Bower

That Staff award the contract for Accessible Pedestrian Signal installation, to the Regional Municipality of Durham in the amount of $281,983.65 (tax exempt).

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

6.1 OES-2021-17: Draft Recreation and Parks Master Plan

Todd Brown, President and Anand Desai, Associate Planner, Monteith Brown Planning Consultants, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. T. Brown discussed the purpose of the Recreation and Parks Master Plan (RPMP), notable elements of Ajax's recreation and parks system, benefits of recreation and parks, community engagement initiatives, and infill and intensification-related development. A. Desai reviewed conceptual plan development for the Ajax Community Centre, Pickering Village Community Centre, and Phase 3 of Audley

Recreation Centre, and discussed plans for the Magnum Opus Community Park, enhancing existing parks, serving youth and seniors, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding usage of rectangular fields, opportunities to include a cricket pitch in the RPMP, recreation domes, potential revenues from batting cages, rationale for exclusion of cultural arts in the RPMP, and public consultation strategies. T. Brown, A. Desai, D. Meredith, Chris Vida, Acting Director of Recreation, Culture & Community Development, and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Draft Recreation and Parks Master Plan, prepared by Monteith Brown Planning Consultants, dated November 2021 be received for information.

CARRIED

6.2 PDS-2021-51: Community Improvement Program Review: Future Direction Recommendations

Mike Sawchuck, Senior Planner, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein. M. Sawchuck reviewed program background, progress to date, and development of recommendations. M. Sawchuck discussed retention versus elimination of Community Improvement Programs (CIPs), evaluation of existing programs, introduction of new programs, interim measures and considerations, and staff recommendations.

Committee Members asked questions regarding impacts to the Medallion project, opportunities to implement a site specific CIP for Hunt Street, projected costs and timelines associated with a CIP on the Hunt Street lands, tax impacts to the Town, and opportunities to consider implementation of a façade program in the downtown CIP. M. Sawchuck, D. Valentim, and G. Romanowski, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That staff be authorized to undertake amendments to the Downtown and Pickering Village Community Improvement Plans to realign them with the Town's strategic objectives, following the process prescribed under Section 28(5) of the *Planning Act,* including the prescribed consultation process;

2. That program suspensions under the Downtown and Pickering Village Community Improvement Plans be introduced or extended until July 1, 2023 (or to the date of implementation for any amended Community Improvement Plan, whichever is sooner) for the following programs:

    a. Downtown Community Improvement Plan
        i. Rehabilitation Grant Program *[Extension]*;
        ii. Planning and Development Fees Grant Program *[Extension]*;
        iii. Development Charge Exemption/Grant Program *[Extension]*;
        iv. Reduced Parkland Dedication Requirements Program *[New Suspension]*;

b. Pickering Village Community Improvement Plan
   i. Development Tax Rebate Program *[Extension]*;
   ii. Planning and Development Fees Rebate Program *[Extension]*;
   iii. Development Charge Exemption/Reduction Program *[Extension]*;
   iv. Reduced Parkland Dedication Requirements Program *[Extension]*;

3. That staff be authorized to continue to set aside Planning and Development fees collected during program suspensions into a dedicated holding account, when received from applicants who have submitted a Community Improvement Plan application and would have been eligible under the Planning and Development Fees Grant Program prior to program suspension, in order to minimize future tax impacts where rebates are approved; and

4. That the 2022 Capital Budget be amended to include a CIP Review capital project, funded from Strategic Initiatives reserve in the amount of $50,000.

CARRIED

7. Closed Session

None

8. Adjournment (3:03 p.m.)

Moved by: A. Khan

That the December 13, 2021 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED